

Jesus' One-Time Offering Called Done

Open to Romans 3. We will begin around verse 19.

For the last two or three months, we have made it only a little past the opening statements. Paul was explaining something to the Jewish community at Rome. In chapter 7 he says, "I speak to them that know the law." He was explaining how swine-eating Gentiles who had never kept a day of the law in their lives were suddenly coming into the full inheritance of Abraham, God, and salvation.

He was explaining why the Gentile is also righteous when he meets Jesus.

Then there were Judaizers who accepted the Gentile but taught that to be perfected, they had to go on and keep principles like the Sabbath. Then it would always extend to feast days. Once that list starts, it never stops.

Paul was explaining the difference between the righteousness the Jew had under the law and the righteousness that comes by faith. Under the law, righteousness was by observances. They could not keep the Ten Commandments out of their nature, but they could keep the observances. They kept the Sabbath, and once a year the high priest went in with blood and offered atonement.

When the Gentile got born again, the law became written in his heart. The nature to keep it literally became part of his born-again spirit.

By Romans 3, Paul is explaining why and to whom the law was given. Verse 19 says:

Now we know that what things soever the law saith, it saith to them who are under the law.

That is the Jew.

Then:

That every mouth may be stopped, and all the world may become guilty before God.

Therefore:

By the deeds of the law there shall no flesh be justified in his sight: for by the law is the knowledge of sin.

God picked the nation of Israel, gave them the law, and lifted them up, fully knowing they could not keep it. Only one Man managed to keep the law, and that was Jesus, out of the nature He came to this planet with.

After keeping the law and fulfilling it, He turned around, stepped into the shoes of every Jew who could not keep it, and became the curse of the law to free them to receive the new nature.

God gave the law to one nation, knowing they could not keep it, so He could look at every other nation and declare them guilty too. If Israel could not keep it, no one else could. By the law is the knowledge of sin.

Every mouth was stopped, and the entire world was declared guilty before God, because He gave the law to Israel as a standard, knowing they could not keep it, then judged the rest of the world by it.

Go to Romans 7:7:

What shall we say then? Is the law sin? God forbid.

Paul is speaking hypothetically in the place of every Jew.

Nay, I had not known sin, but by the law: for I had not known lust, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet.

The whole human race was born with the sin nature. When you are born with it, you do not know it as sin because you have always had it. Until God gave the law, Paul says, "I would not have known what sin was except the law told me it was wrong and not to covet."

That is how Romans 7 follows. Speaking hypothetically as every Jew, when they tried to do what the law said, Paul says:

The good that I would I do not: but the evil which I would not, that I do.

Then:

It is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.

And:

In my flesh dwelleth no good thing.

Everybody uses "it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me" to separate righteousness from works of the flesh. You cannot do that. Paul was not talking about a born-again man having trouble with his flesh. He was hypothetically speaking in the place of every Jew. The chapter starts, "I speak to them that know the law."

The law has dominion over a man as long as he lives. Paul is declaring, "I would not even have known what sin was except the law said, Thou shalt not covet." His nature was free to covet before that because it did not bother him. Then he knew it was wrong, but with the sin nature, he could not stop. The harder he tried to stop, the more it activated the sin, and the harder he sinned.

It caused the dilemma he talks about in Romans 7.

I learned about natures from Mike Wolf Cain. Cain weighed about 140 pounds and could snap our pickets with his teeth and walk out, so a fence did not do much good.

I had to put Cain under law because of his nature. I had to put him on a cable. I hated doing that, because although we were his friends and he was good to us, he would go out into the neighborhood and come back with feathers on his mouth and cat hair.

"Cain, did you kill a cat? Did you kill some chickens?"

He would say no and lie like a dog.

Rosalie collects every kind of little beast, and at that time we had some pygmy goats in the backyard. Cain was chained up, but he was smart. He would act like he was at the end of the cable so the goats would come closer. The female goat had a baby, and we called the baby Abel.

Cain was on the chain. Later we found little Abel's hooves. That was the only thing Cain did not eat.

I warned him not to do it. I said, "Cain, do not do this. You mind me."

He looked at me like, "I will mind you while you are standing there, but you are going to go into the house, and I am going to eat that goat."

He could not help it. That was his nature. He was doing what his nature did.

It is not that God did not love the Old Testament saints. My God, He loved them. But His fellowship with them was limited by their sin nature. That is why Paul said, "I would not even have known sin, except the law said stop." When they tried to stop, they could not.

That is why Romans 3 says the law says what it says to those under the law, that every mouth may be stopped and the whole world declared guilty before God. Nobody could keep the law.

Romans 7:5 says:

For when we were in the flesh, the motions of sins, which were by the law, did work in our members to bring forth fruit unto death.

"When we were in the flesh" means when they had a spiritually dead nature that had ascendancy over their minds, and they could not quit sinning.

That is why Romans 8 says:

There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

There is no more of that kind of condemnation for the Jew who no longer walks after the death nature but has been born again and made free. Do not take Romans 8 out of context. Of course, we Gentiles were the same. We had a death nature and could not keep it either, and we have been born again.

Notice the motions of sin in Romans 7:5. The motions of sin are what set sin into motion like a locomotive. When the law says, "No, you cannot commit adultery," that sets the death nature into motion.

Then Romans 7:6 says:

But now we are delivered from the law, that being dead wherein we were held.

The old man that the law had hold over and forced into sin died. When he died, the law lost its hold over him. That is why Paul can say we are delivered from the law, that being dead wherein we were held, so we should serve in newness of spirit and not in the oldness of the letter.

By the time we get to Romans 10, Paul is still defining the same difference. When he gives us those classic verses on being born again, he is explaining righteousness under the law and the righteousness given to those who are born again.

Romans 10:1 says:

Brethren, my heart's desire and prayer to God for Israel is, that they might be saved.

Someone told me somebody was preaching that they all already are. I guess they have not read Romans.

Paul says:

For I bear them record that they have a zeal of God, but not according to knowledge.

For they being ignorant of God's righteousness, and going about to establish their own righteousness, have not submitted themselves unto the righteousness of God.

For Christ is the end of the law for righteousness to every one that believeth.

Moses describes the righteousness which is of the law: the man who does those things shall live by them. But the righteousness which is of faith speaks this way:

Say not in thine heart, Who shall ascend into heaven? (that is, to bring Christ down from above:)

Or, Who shall descend into the deep? (that is, to bring up Christ again from the dead.)

Then:

The word is nigh thee, even in thy mouth, and in thy heart.

That is the word of faith which we preach:

That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved.

For with the heart man believes unto righteousness, and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.

I was not supposed to say in my heart, "Who will ascend into heaven and bring Christ down from above? Who will descend into the deep and raise Him from the dead again?" I read that hundreds of times before I knew why I was not supposed to say it.

Faith says the Word is near you, in your mouth and heart.

Romans 10 says:

How beautiful are the feet of them that preach the gospel of peace, and bring glad tidings of good things.

Paul did not stop with righteousness, saying if you confess with your mouth and believe with your heart you will be saved. He mentions the glad tidings of good things.

Not only was I born again, but I was freed from everything else. The devil lost his power over me. I do not have a sin nature anymore. Jesus judged sickness and disease. It does not have power to reign here anymore. He destroyed the hold the devil had over me.

Jesus said:

Behold, I give unto you power... over all the power of the enemy.

The devil does not have power to rule over you.

Paul was saying to the Jew that law-righteousness meant you lived in those things, did those things, offered sacrifices, performed washings, and kept feast days. That is where your righteousness stood.

But the righteousness which is by faith says, "Do not say every year, Who is going to go into heaven and bring Jesus down? Who is going to resurrect Him from the dead every year so He can offer salvation again, the same as the high priest every year entered the holiest of holies to offer atonement for our sins?"

Jesus is not going to be crucified every year. You are not going to bring Him down and crucify Him and raise Him from the dead every year. He is not going to do this again. He will only do it one time: victory over all your disease, over your sin, over the devil.

All those things have been defeated. Since He is not going to do it for you anymore, you might as well stop and learn how to believe what He has already done for you.

So can I ask Him eighty-five times to heal me? He is not going to provide it again. He is not going to provide salvation again. He provided that one time and gave us absolute victory over everything.

The confession Paul is talking about is confession of a final event already done, not only confessing the Lord Jesus Christ as my Lord and being made righteous, but also the glad tidings of good things. The good news is that on the same cross He destroyed sickness and disease, and I do not have to have that any more than I have to have sin.

Since He is not going to provide it anymore, I am going to find out how to stop and make the kind of stand that wins.

We have been preaching a lot on a place called done: the place where you take what Jesus has done for you, which God has provided for you, and you drop it off with Him with such finality that you have peace.

You do not have to have unrest. You do not have to lose sleep, be full of fear, or have any of those things.

The more He took me onto that limb of love, the more I realized the finality with which I could bring something to Him and leave it. He is not going to provide anything else for me again. It is all done. That means there is a place where you can find out the full execution of that finished work, where it is done.

When I first got into the faith move, the journey from discovering verses like "All things are possible to him that believeth," "Nothing shall be impossible unto you," "The works I do shall you do also, and greater works," and "You can say to the sycamine tree," seemed longer than most people's lives.

Yet the closer I got to knowing Him, the closer I got to knowing what He provided for me. The more I understood what He provided, the more final it became. A place called done began to form. I know whether it is you, a loved one, or disease, you can drop it off with Him with such finality that you know He is not going to come back and provide it again.

I am finding out how to accept that the one time is done.

When we went to Yucca Valley, David went, and pretty much the whole family went. I was preaching up in the high desert. God answered a man's prayer there in Yucca Valley after the man had laid his whole life on the line. He did not want to live anymore unless God answered this for him.

My oldest son David likes to hunt the desert. He is not afraid of anything, not even rattlesnakes. He hunts them down and grabs them with his hands. He has been bitten about three times.

He took the van we rented way out in the desert and finally found a little crossroads place with a small store or gas station. He may have been asking directions or asking for a better place to hunt. The man came out of the little store and walked up by the van. They were talking for a minute, and he looked in the back and saw one of the books, *The Walk of the Spirit*, *The Walk of Power*, in the back seat.

He stopped, looked at David, and said, "Where did you get that book?"

David said, "My dad wrote it."

The man said, "Yeah, right."

So David got out his driver's license and showed it to him. The man stepped back and turned white.

Then I found out more of the story. He said, "This morning I prayed to God. My family used to go to a little Pentecostal church. I have been hurt." Three foster kids had been killed in a car wreck a few months earlier. He said, "I do not believe in a God who would take a man's family. This morning I prayed, 'God, if I could meet the man who wrote that book by tonight, I would believe there is a God.'"

His wife had gotten hold of the book and was beginning to enjoy it.

David said, "Get in the car." He drove him back, and we prayed for him on the sidewalk. He fell under the power, lay there about forty-five minutes, and got up saying, "There is a God."

He reached God in a desperate place.

After we are done with all our reasons why God should do something and the way He should do it, after all our instructions to Him, codes in the Bible, and formulas, there is really only one reason He does a miracle for you: because He loves you.

He does not need another reason.

Do not say, "He left me sick so I could lie in the hospital and testify to somebody." God could orchestrate it another way. Why would He need you to get sick so you could talk to the person in the next bed? Why could He not just say, "Go to the hospital and sit down and talk to that man"?

The fewer formulas, codes, and timings you look for, the easier it is to realize the primary reason by grace He wants to heal and set a person free: because He loves them.

When you drop people and things off in His presence, do it knowing He provided it for you when you were yet in sin. He loved you and sent Jesus to the cross.

When you are bargaining with God, forget the bargaining. The number one reason He will do anything for anyone is because He loves them.

"I need to coax Him with something. I need to make some promises."

No. What kind of God do you think you serve, that you have to give Him a reason to motivate Him to do something that cost heaven everything?

When I take somebody or something and drop it off with Him, I approach Him armed with one thing: I know how much You love them, and I know how much You love me. I am about to drop somebody off at that place called done, and I am going to turn away knowing it is done.

Why stay up all night and pray and travail? If I did, I would not use it as a reason to make you think I was more holy. I would stay up and pray all night because I love Him and want to be about His business.

Was it staying up all night praying that got it done? No. It was worshiping, glorifying, and loving Him that freed Him to do what He wanted to do the whole time. He is always searching for ways into our lives. Our thinking is that we have to get Him to come into our lives. His thinking is that He is always searching for a way in.

I am not going to say in my heart, "Bring Him down again. Put Him together. Provide the whole thing for me again." I am learning how to receive from the one-time offering He made and gave to me.

I am going to find out how much He loves me, and in finding that out I will find out how thoroughly He has given me everything.

The last time I tried to bargain with Him was over the resurrection of somebody who died. I started offering my future to Him: "God, if You will just come and do this, I will have seasons of fasting and prayer. Can we prorate this? You do this now for what I will do for You in the future."

God may move occasionally like that, mostly for babies. But instead of bargaining, "I will pray more," you should be saying, "I am giving my future to You because I have fallen in love with You. I appreciate the fellowship I have with You, and I know You are going to raise this person because You love them as much as You love me."

Someone says, "I would feel more loved if I did not feel condemned all the time."

That is not Him. If you feel condemned, why do you not stop? There is a difference between conviction and condemnation. If I come under conviction, there is an immediate answer. Condemnation is different, and we are usually very good at condemning ourselves.

A woman came to me and said, "I know God is not answering me."

I asked, "Why?"

She said, "I have disappointed Him so badly. I feel so condemned. I have been wanting to fast longer fasts, like twenty-one days, and all I have been making is three days. Then I fall apart. I know that is why He is not answering me."

I said, "Is that not something? Most of the body of Christ lives in gluttony and does not even know what fasting means, and you are fighting to fast, and you are the one being condemned."

Probably some key angels gathered around, and Michael and Gabriel had a wild party because there was a saint down there knocking off two or three days at a time.

Quite the contrary, you are not being condemned. Heaven is having a party. God welcomes and celebrates every move you try to make toward Him. Every part you achieve, they celebrate in it. They celebrate you even attempting, if you do not achieve it.

You are not in less standing for wanting to know God than the person who does not.

Who comes and mocks everything you try for God? It is not God.

Stop and find out that no matter what you do, you approach Him on the fact that He loves you. And the person you are trying to minister to, He loves them as much as He loves you. The whole reason He came after both of you is because He so loved the world.

Use that on Him. It will work better than your bargains and condemnation.

In Romans 10, Paul says:

| The righteousness which is of faith speaketh on this wise...

Do not say in your heart, "Who will ascend into heaven to bring Christ down?" or "Who will descend into the deep to bring Christ up from the dead?"

What does it say?

| The word is nigh thee, even in thy mouth, and in thy heart.

If you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved. And not only saved. Paul also mentions the glad tidings of good things.

I know He has provided it, so I believe it with my heart and speak it with my mouth because I know He loves me. I know I have victory over all the flesh, the devils, and all the friends of the devils.

Now go to Hebrews 9:24:

For Christ is not entered into the holy places made with hands, which are the figures of the true; but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God for us.

Then:

Nor yet that he should offer himself often, as the high priest entereth into the holy place every year with blood of others.

If that were true, then He would have had to suffer since the foundation of the world. So do not say in your heart, "Who will ascend into heaven and bring Him down to offer it and provide it all again? Who will raise Him from the dead to provide it all again?"

Hebrews continues:

But now once in the end of the world hath he appeared to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself.

Notice the terminology: once, in the end of the world.

Then:

And as it is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment:
So Christ was once offered to bear the sins of many...

As we take this further, we will get into what happened when He offered Himself once at the end of the world. It caused something incredible to happen at His death.

Why did Hebrews call the cross the end of the world? It caused a reaction to take place. If you know how to follow it, it will establish that place called done so solidly that He can begin to tell you what to do with your prayers.

Once this Man offered Himself at the end of the world, and it is appointed unto man once to die and after that the judgment, you ask, "Did the world end two thousand years ago?"

Yes, it did.

We will explain that in the next service, or Wednesday, or Sunday.

Hallelujah.